



Review of Related Literature: Need, Purpose & Planning

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Learning Objectives

After studying this chapter, **YOU** should be able to understand:

- What is meant by literature review?
- Functions of literature review
- Steps of literature review

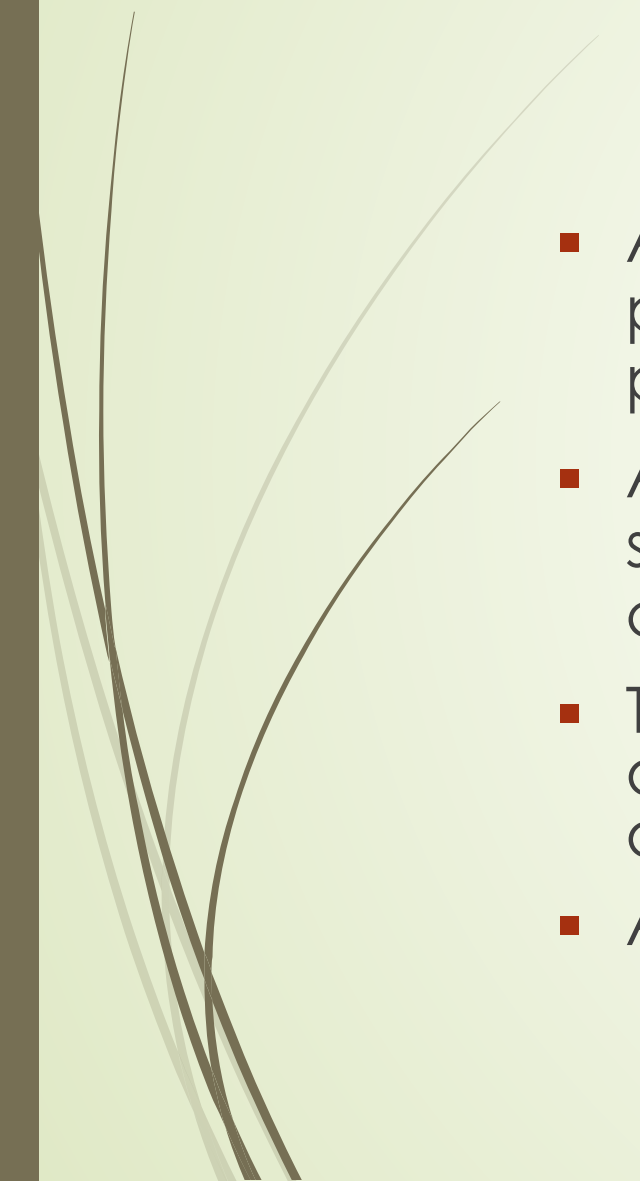


Meaning (Re + View)

- **to view or see again.**
- to examine or study again especially
- to reexamine judicially.
- to look back on : take a retrospective view of review the past.
- to go over or examine critically or deliberately reviewed the results of the study.
- to give a critical evaluation



What is Literature review

- A literature review discusses published information in a particular subject area, and sometimes information in a particular subject area within a certain time period.
 - A literature review can be just a simple summary of the sources, but it usually has an organizational pattern and combines both summary and synthesis.
 - The format of a review of literature may vary from discipline to discipline and from assignment to assignment.
 - A review may be a self-contained unit.
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Literature Review : A Process

- The literature review: A **synthesis** of studies on any given topic.
- Usually **precedes a full-length original study** as a way of introducing the general topic.
- **Its purpose:** To help the reader understand the background to your study and see how it's the next logical study to be conducted in this domain.
- Necessarily, a good literature review requires a **thoroughly** researched topic.
- Be prepared for a writing **process**. Do *not* attempt to write a literature review over night. This process takes weeks and months. **Yes, months.**



TYPES OF REVIEW

The literature review can be classified and studies can be placed under following types:

- Evaluative Review
- Exploratory Review
- Instrumental Review
- Systematic Review



► **Evaluative Review**

Evaluative review focuses on the findings of the researches. The evaluative review is already reviewed and evaluated by experts. This type of review provides idea about the worth of the researchers study as it has been compared by the researchers.



► **Exploratory Review**

Exploratory review tells what are the best explored researches its outcomes and the areas still to be explored. This review provides direction to the researcher to choose the best way to study and gives idea about areas that are to be considered for the study



► Instrumental Review

Instrumental review does not tell about the research but tells how to conduct and proceed with the research. This research provides researcher the best way to conduct the research.



► **Systematic Review**

Systematic review critically analyses the researches, its procedures, methodology, analysis and the result. This type of review helps the researcher to sort the researches needed for the current study.

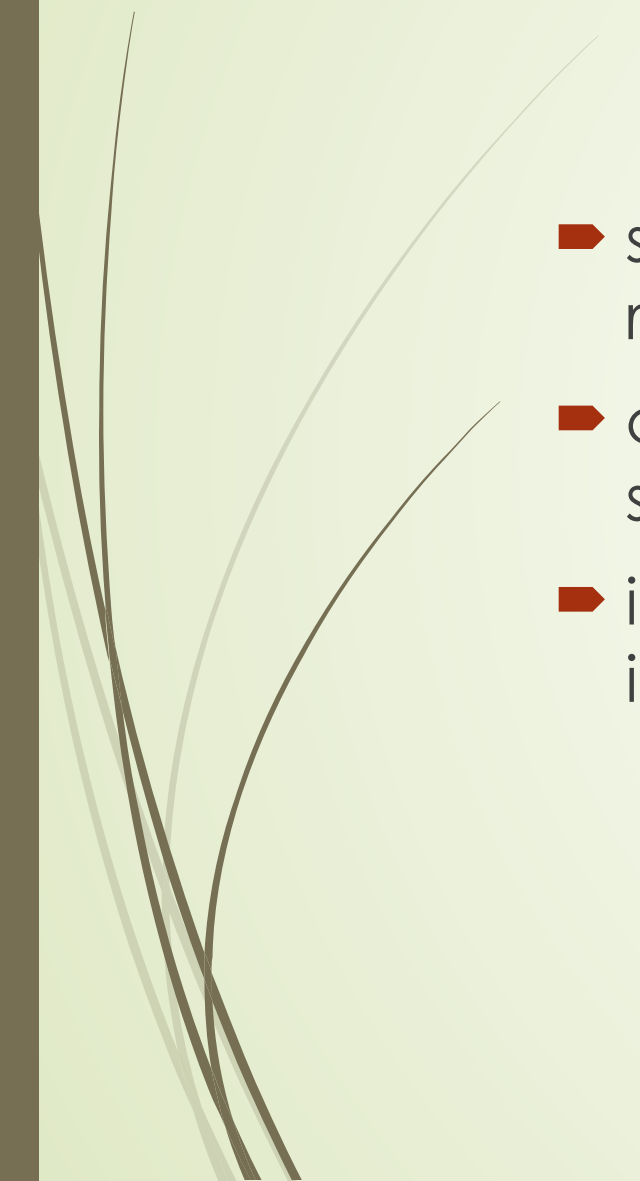


Why write Literature Review?

- The purpose of a literature review is for you to take a critical look at the literature (facts and views) that already exists in the area you are researching.
 - Literature can include books, journal articles, internet (electronic journals), newspapers, magazines, theses and dissertations, conference proceedings, reports, and documentaries.
 - Literature reviews are written occasionally in the humanities, but mostly in the sciences and social sciences; in experiment and lab reports, they constitute a section of the paper.
 - Sometimes a literature review is written as a paper in itself.
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- In the context of a research paper on a thesis, the literature review provides a background to the study being proposed.
 - The background may consider one or more of the following aspects depending on the research question being posed:
 - Theoretical background – past, present or future
 - Clinical practice – previous or contemporary
 - Methodology and/or research methods
 - Previous findings
 - Rationale and/or relevance of the current study

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- Bring clarity and focus to your research problem
 - Improves methodology
 - Broaden your knowledge base in your research area
 - Contextualize your findings
 - The problem identified by you has already been researched.
 - Will help in forming research questions.
 - Will get an idea of how to proceed with design of the study.
 - Can identify appropriate data collection instruments.

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- shows changes in a particular field over time, from early research to the most recent developments
 - clarifies areas of controversy and consensus among scholars, as well as dominant views within the field
 - identifies research gaps and justifies your research by indicating the contribution it will make to the field



What should I do before writing the literature review?

➤ Clarify

- If your assignment is not very specific, seek clarification from your supervisor/lecturer:
- Roughly how many sources should you include?
- What types of sources (books, journal articles, websites)?
- Should you summarize, synthesize, or critique your sources by discussing a common theme or issue?
- Should you evaluate your sources?
- Should you provide subheadings and other background information, such as definitions and/or a history?



➤ Find models

- Look for other literature reviews in your area of interest or in the discipline and read them to get a sense of the types of themes you might want to look for in your own research or ways to organize your final review. You can simply put the word "review" in your search engine along with your other topic terms to find articles of this type on the Internet or in an electronic database. The bibliography or reference section of sources you've already read are also excellent entry points into your own research.



➤ **Narrow your topic**

- There are hundreds or even thousands of articles and books on most areas of study. The narrower your topic, the easier it will be to limit the number of sources you need to read in order to get a good survey of the material. Your instructor will probably not expect you to read everything that's out there on the topic, but you'll make your job easier if you first limit your scope.

➤ **Consider whether your sources are current**

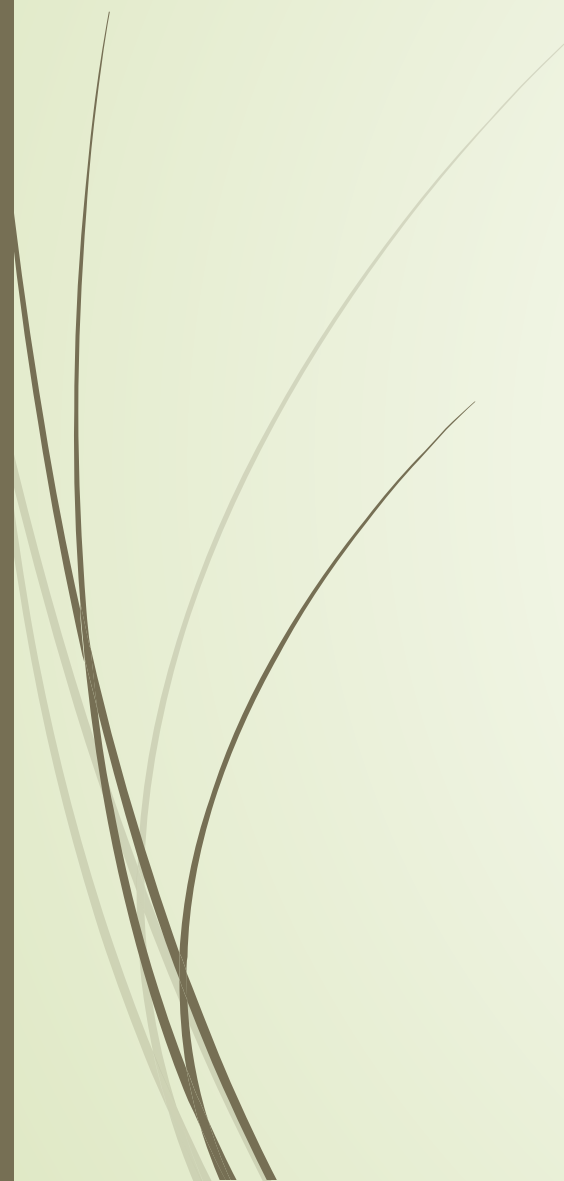
- Some disciplines require that you use information that is as current as possible. In the sciences, for instance, treatments for medical problems are constantly changing according to the latest studies. Information even two years old could be obsolete.

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- However, if you are writing a review in the humanities, history, or social sciences, a survey of the history of the literature may be what is needed, because what is important is how perspectives have changed through the years or within a certain time period.
 - Try sorting through some other current bibliographies or literature reviews in the field to get a sense of what your discipline expects.
 - You can also use this method to consider what is "hot" and what is not.



► Find a focus

- A literature review, like a term paper, is usually organized around ideas, not the sources themselves as an annotated bibliography would be organized. This means that you will not just simply list your sources and go into detail about each one of them, one at a time.

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- As you read widely but selectively in your topic area, consider instead what themes or issues connect your sources together.
 - Do they present one or different solutions?
 - Is there an aspect of the field that is missing?
 - How well do they present the material and do they portray it according to an appropriate theory?
 - Do they reveal a trend in the field?
 - A raging debate?
 - Pick one of these themes to focus the organization of your review.



► **Construct a working thesis statement**

- Then use the focus you've found to construct a thesis statement. Yes! Literature reviews have thesis statements as well! However, your thesis statement will not necessarily argue for a position or an opinion; rather it will argue for a particular perspective on the material.

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- Some sample thesis statements for literature reviews are as follows:
 - *The current trend in treatment for congestive heart failure combines surgery and medicine.*
 - *More and more cultural studies scholars are accepting popular media as a subject worthy of academic consideration.*



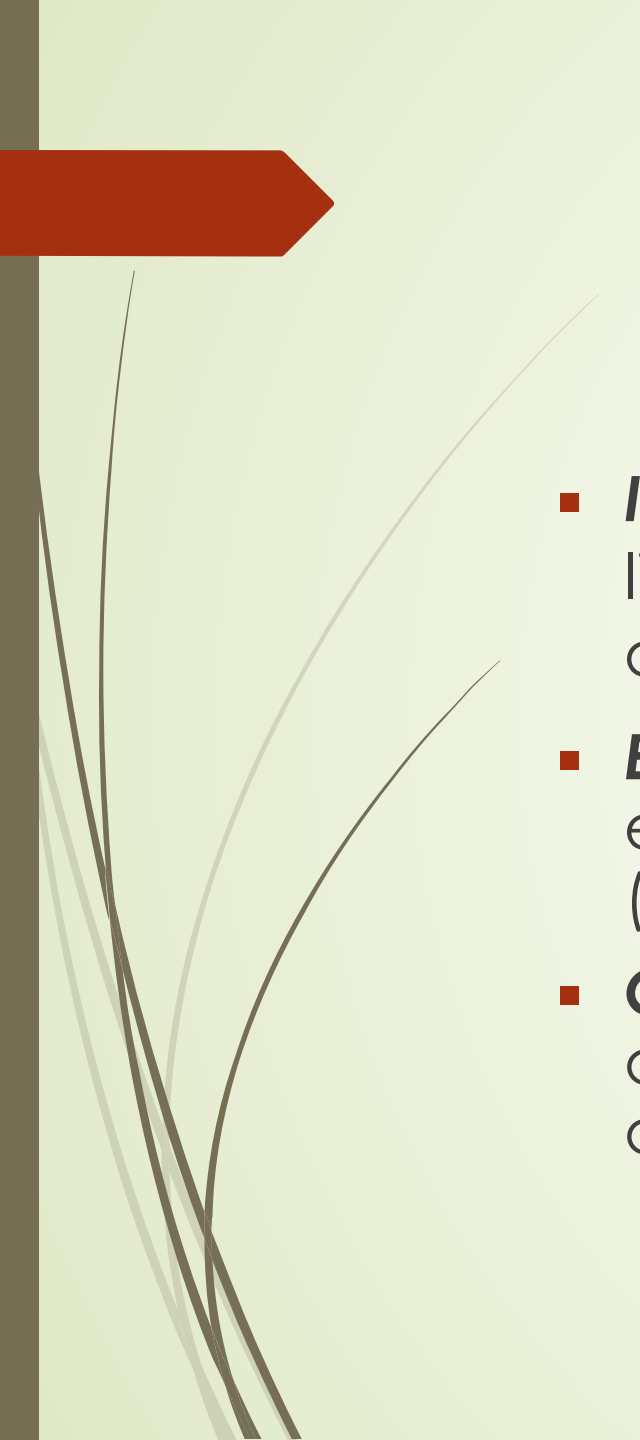
► **Consider organization**

- You've got a focus, and you've narrowed it down to a thesis statement.
- Now what is the most effective way of presenting the information?
- What are the most important topics, subtopics, etc., that your review needs to include?
- And in what order should you present them?

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- Develop an organization for your review at both a global and local level:

First, cover the basic categories

- Just like most academic papers, literature reviews also must contain at least three basic elements: an introduction or background information section; the body of the review containing the discussion of sources; and, finally, a conclusion and/or recommendations section to end the paper.

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- **Introduction:** Gives a quick idea of the topic of the literature review, such as the central theme or organizational pattern.
 - **Body:** Contains your discussion of sources and is organized either chronologically, thematically, or methodologically (see below for more information on each).
 - **Conclusions/Recommendations:** Discuss what you have drawn from reviewing literature so far. Where might the discussion proceed?

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- **The introduction** should provide the reader with the scale and structure of your review. It serves as a kind of map.
 - **The body** of the review depends on how you have organized your key points. Literature reviews at postgraduate level should be evaluative and not merely descriptive. For example possible reasons for similarities or differences between studies are considered rather than a mere identification of them.
 - **The conclusion** of the review needs to sum up the main findings of your research into the literature. The findings can be related to the aims of the study you are proposing to do. The reader is thus provided with a coherent background to the current study.



► Organizing the body

- Once you have the basic categories in place, then you must consider how you will present the sources themselves within the body of your paper. Create an organizational method to focus this section even further.
- To help you come up with an overall organizational framework for your review, consider the six typical ways of organizing the sources into a review:
 - *Chronological*
 - *By publication*
 - *By trend*
 - *Thematic*
 - *Methodological*
 - *Questions for Further Research*

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- Similar to primary research, development of the literature review requires four stages:
 - **Problem formulation**—which topic or field is being examined and what are its component issues?
 - **Literature search**—finding materials relevant to the subject being explored
 - **Data evaluation**—determining which literature makes a significant contribution to the understanding of the topic
 - **Analysis and interpretation**—discussing the findings and conclusions of pertinent literature

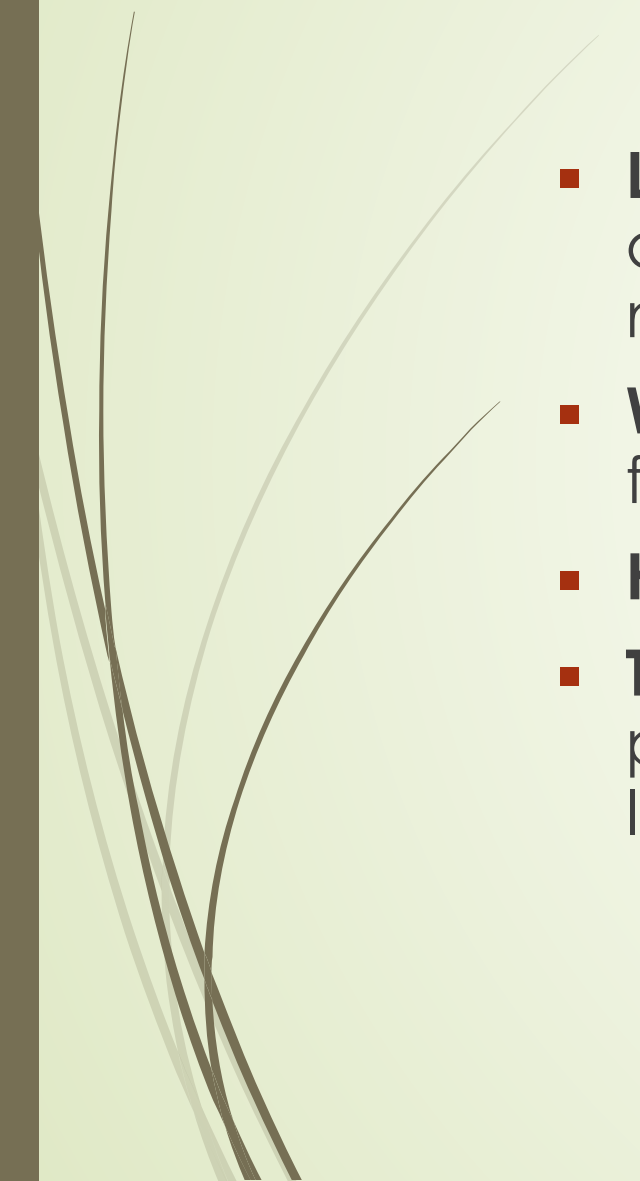


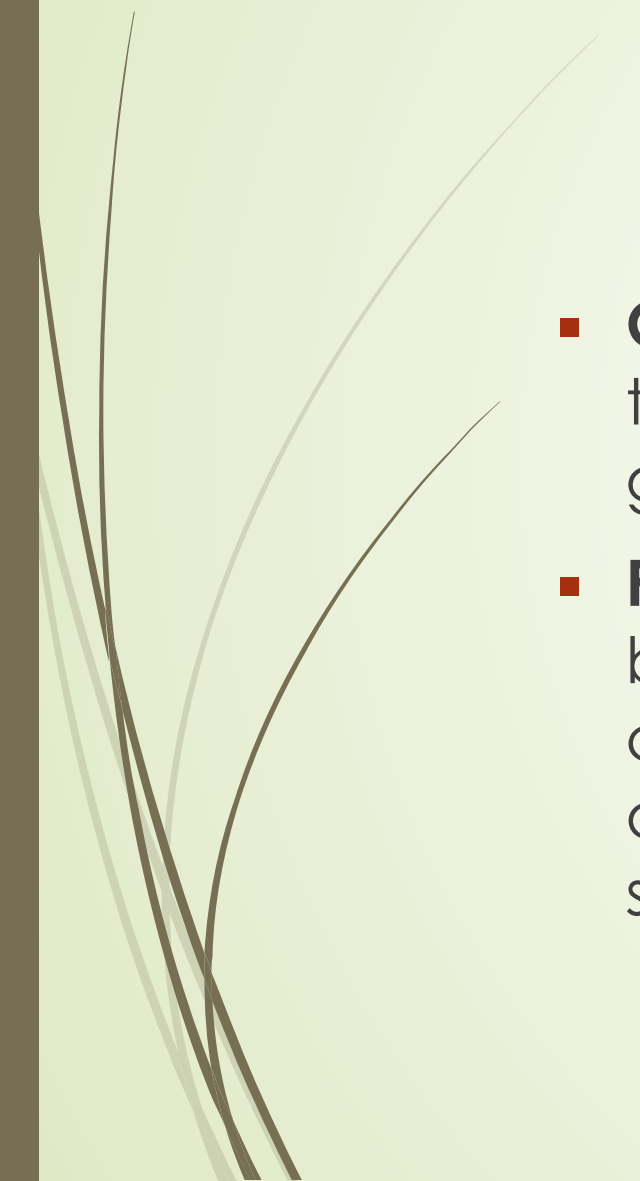
What should you write?

- the accepted facts in the area
- the popular opinion
- the main variables
- the relationship between concepts and variables
- shortcomings in the existing findings
- limitations in the methods used in the existing findings
- the relevance of your research
- suggestions for further research in the area.

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- Literature reviews should comprise the following elements:
 - An overview of the subject, issue or theory under consideration, along with the objectives of the literature review
 - Division of works under review into categories (e.g. those in support of a particular position, those against, and those offering alternative theses entirely)
 - Explanation of how each work is similar to and how it varies from the others
 - Conclusions as to which pieces are best considered in their argument, are most convincing of their opinions, and make the greatest contribution to the understanding and development of their area of research

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- In assessing each piece, consideration should be given to:
 - **Provenance**—What are the author's credentials? Are the author's arguments supported by evidence (e.g. primary historical material, case studies, narratives, statistics, recent scientific findings)?
 - **Objectivity**—Is the author's perspective even-handed or prejudicial? Is contrary data considered or is certain pertinent information ignored to prove the author's point?
 - **Persuasiveness**—Which of the author's theses are most/least convincing?
 - **Value**—Are the author's arguments and conclusions convincing? Does the work ultimately contribute in any significant way to an understanding of the subject?

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- **Layout** : Make your literature review have an academic and professional appearance. Here are some points to make the look of your report appealing to the reader
 - **White space**: leave space between sections, especially from the abstract. This gives an uncluttered effect.
 - **Headings/sub-headings**: these help to separate ideas.
 - **Text boxes**: you can use these for quotations or paraphrasing to separate them from the rest of your text. It is also pleasing to the eye.

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- **Graphics:** centre your graphics, such as diagrams or tables, to have space around them. Try not to bury graphics in your text.
 - **Pagination:** you can number pages or sections or both, but the important thing to do is to be consistent. The cover page normally is not numbered. The content page and abstract page usually have a separate numbering system to the body of your literature review.



■ Language focus

- Create a balance between direct quotation (citation) and paraphrasing. Avoid too much direct quoting. The verb tense chosen depends on your emphasis:
- When you are citing a specific author's findings, use the past tense: (found, demonstrated);
- When you are writing about an accepted fact, use the present tense: (demonstrates, finds); and
- When you are citing several authors or making a general statement, use the present perfect tense: (have shown, have found, little research has been done).



➤ Final checklist

- Have I fulfilled the purpose of the literature review?
 - Is it written at a level appropriate to its audience?
 - Are its facts correct?
 - Is all the information included relevant?
 - Are the layout and presentation easy on the eye?
 - Is the language clear, concise and academic?
 - Does the abstract summarise the entire review?
 - Does the introduction adequately introduce the topic?
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- Is the body organised logically?
 - Does the conclusion interpret, analyse and evaluate?
 - Are the recommendations reasonable?
 - Does the table of contents correspond with the actual contents? Are page numbers correct?
 - Have I acknowledged all sources of information through correct referencing?
 - Have I checked spelling, grammar and punctuation?
 - Have I carefully proof-read the final draft?



How to review?

- The whole process of reviewing includes:
 - a. Searching for literature
 - b. Sorting and prioritizing the retrieved literature
 - c. Analytical reading of papers
 - d. Evaluative reading of papers
 - e. Comparison across studies
 - f. Organizing the content
 - g. Writing the review



■ Comparison across studies

- The aim is to extract key points by comparing and contrasting ACROSS studies, instead of reading one paper after another.
 - Key points for a review may concern areas of similarities and/or differences in:
 - Research aim(s) or hypotheses
 - Research design and sampling
 - Instruments and procedures used
 - How data were analysed
 - Results or findings
 - Interpretations
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► Find similarities and differences between studies at **different levels**, e.g.:

- philosophy
 - epistemology
 - morality
 - methodology
 - methods
 - types of data
 - data analysis
 - interpretation
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- Set out your thinking on paper through **maps** and **trees**.



➤ Tips on writing





➤ Pitfalls

- Vagueness due to too much or inappropriate generalisations
- Limited range
- Insufficient information
- Irrelevant material
- Omission of contrasting view
- Omission of recent work

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- Early works have addressed some of the problems and issues discussed in video retrieval.

Researchers have developed ideas and tools for supporting video editing, for example in [8]. They have defined a seamless video editing in the gradient domain.

The spatio-temporal gradient fields of target videos are modified or mixed to generate a new gradient field, which is usually not integrate able.

They have also described how semantic information about video can be structured and used for content-based access. From a general video archive point of view, the problem with this tool is the lack of support for managing video document structures.

A digital video archive serving different categories of users should offer a more structured way of describing video contents



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- **Srivastava, S. (2014).** Studies science achievement as predictor of scientific attitude. The researcher describes how science achievement predicts scientific attitude of secondary school students. For this study, researcher collected a sample of 480 IX standard students which includes 240 girls and 240 boys through multistage random sampling. The scientific attitude questionnaire by K S Mishra was adopted by researcher for studying scientific attitude of secondary students. Science achievement test was developed by investigator to measure science achievement of secondary school students. The analysis was done by using t-test and product moment correlation as a statistical tool. The findings states that girls shows more ability to apply knowledge in science than the boys of secondary class but both the gender does not differ in knowledge and comprehension in science from one another. It indicates that female students with high achievement in science are more likely to have high level of scientific attitude in intent as well as action while achievement in science do not influence scientific attitude in intent as well as action among male students. Findings indicate that male students with more ability to comprehend in science are not likely to have better scientific attitude in their action. Perhaps male students perceive more stress in their environment and it might negatively affect the development of scientific attitude in action. So, science educators should provide more personal autonomy to male students and increase their motivation for learning science.



SCOPE OF REVIEW

- How many studies do you need to look at?
 - How comprehensive should it be?
 - How many years should it cover?
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TYPES OF SOURCES

- Primary Sources
 - Secondary Sources
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PRIMARY SOURCES

- Primary sources were either created during the time period being studied or were created at a later date by a participant in the events being studied, such as, a childhood memoir.
- They are original documents (i.e., they are not about another document or account) and reflect the individual viewpoint of a participant or observer.
- Primary sources represent direct, uninterpreted records of the subject of your research study.



EXAMPLES OF PRIMARY DOCUMENTS YOU COULD REVIEW AS PART OF YOUR OVERALL STUDY INCLUDE

- Artifacts (e.g. furniture or clothing, all from the time under study);
- Audio recordings (e.g. radio programs)
- Diaries; * Internet communications on email,
- Interviews (e.g., oral histories, telephone, e-mail);
- Letters; * Newspaper articles written at the time;
- Original Documents (i.e. birth certificate, will, marriage license, trial transcript);
- Patents;

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- Photographs
 - Proceedings of Meetings, conferences and symposia;
 - Records of organizations, government agencies (e.g. annual report, treaty, constitution, government document); Speeches;
 - Survey Research (e.g., market surveys, public opinion polls);
 - Transcripts of radio and television programs
 - Video recordings;
 - Works of art, architecture, literature, and music (e.g., paintings, sculptures, musical scores, buildings, novels, poems)



SECONDARY SOURCES

- ▶ They are interpretations and evaluations of primary sources.
- ▶ Secondary sources are not evidence, but rather, commentary on and discussion of evidence.
- ▶ They represent various opinions, interpretations, and arguments about the research problem you are investigating--opinions, interpretations, and arguments with which you may either agree or disagree with as part of your own analysis of the literature



EXAMPLES OF SECONDARY SOURCES YOU COULD REVIEW AS PART OF YOUR OVERALL STUDY INCLUDE

- Bibliographies
 - Books, other than fiction and autobiography;
 - Commentaries, criticisms;
 - Dictionaries, Encyclopaedias
 - Histories;
 - Journal articles
 - Magazine and newspaper articles
 - Textbooks
 - Web site
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WHERE TO SEARCH FOR EXISTING LITERATURE?

- ❑ Books
 - ❑ Journals
 - ❑ Computer Database
 - ERIC
 - PsycINFO
 - SocINDEX
 - UMI Dissertation
 - ❑ Google Scholar
 - ❑ JSTOR
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- EBSCO
 - Magazine and newspapers
 - Conference proceedings and papers
 - Monographs
 - Dissertations
 - Doctoral theses
 - Personal communication: interviews, presentations, lectures
 - Government reports and reports from other organizations



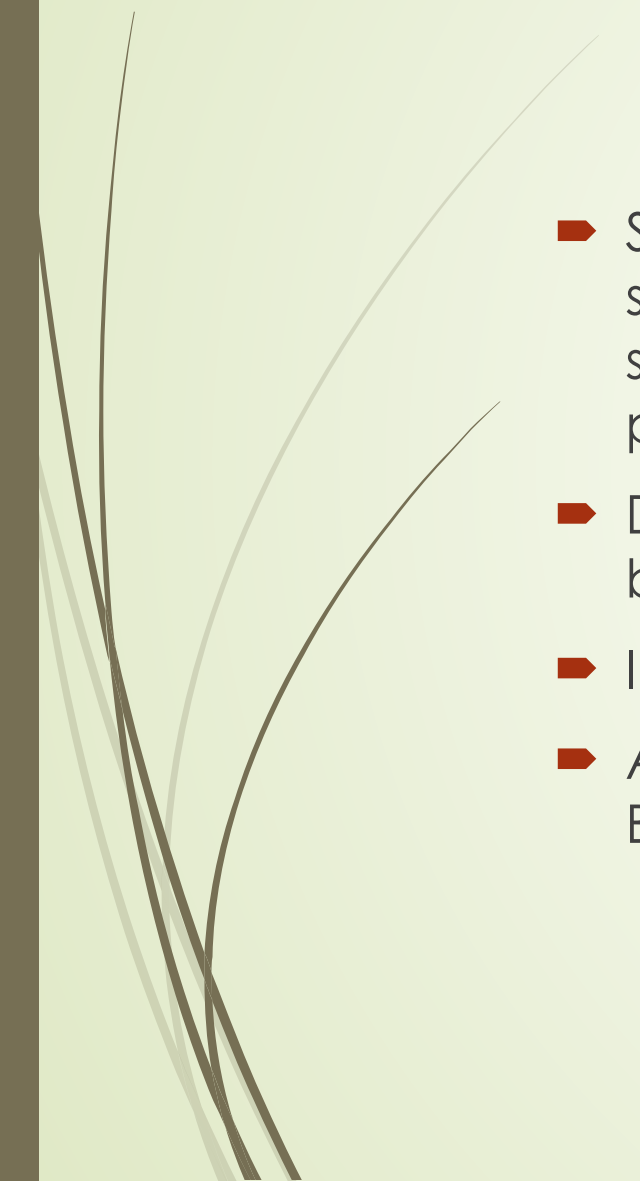
ABSTRACTS

- capsule reports or summaries

ERIC- the Educational resources information centre: repository of documents on education. National decentralized information centres of USA

It contains lists of titles, abstracts, research reviews, bibliography etc. It covers career education, counselling and personal services, early childhood education, education management, education of gifted children etc.

Psychological abstracts information services (PsycINF) Psychological abstracts : (1927) approx. 900 journals, technical reports, monographs and other scientific documents. Areas covered are general Psychology, Psychometrics, Experimental Psychology etc.

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- Sociological abstracts: American sociological association: It includes social psychology, group interaction, culture and social structure, social change and economic development, social control, policy planning, studies on violence etc.
 - Dissertation abstracts international : A major research source in behavioural sciences
 - Indian Education abstracts NCERT:
 - A survey of Research in Education: Prof. MS Buch, MS University Baroda



INDEXES



- It lists titles categorized according to headings or description but does not provide abstracts or any other description of the documents.
- American doctoral dissertation: list of all doctoral dissertation accepted by American and Canadian universities
- Education Index
- Current index to journals in education
- British Education Index
- Humanities Index
- Social Science Index: Anthropology, arts studies, economics, geography, law, political sciences, public administration



ENCYCLOPEDIAS



- Huge storehouse of information containing articles written by specialists in their respective fields.
- Encyclopaedia of Education
- Encyclopaedia of Educational Evaluation
- Encyclopaedia Educational Research
- Encyclopaedia of Modern Education
- The International Encyclopaedia Of the social Sciences
- Encyclopaedia of Children and guidance
- Encyclopaedia of Philosophy



HAND BOOKS/YEAR BOOKS

- Reference Books or other collection of instructions that are intended to provide ready reference.
- Handbook of Academic Evaluation
- Handbook Research on Teaching
- Handbook of Formative and summative Evaluation of student Learning

Records, highlights the events and achievements of the past year of a particular organization, nation or universe. Mental Measurement Yearbook Education Yearbook



PROCESS OF CONDUCTING LITERATURE REVIEW



Step 1:

locate relevant literature

- Identify key texts

Step 2:

Review the literature

- Read key text
- Analyse and evaluate critically

Step 3:

write about the literature

- Synthesis
- Organise

MANAGING SOURCES

- Literature review matrix is a table in which you can represent the views, ideas, or data according to thematic categories

Author	Year	Title	Aims	Method	Sample	Conclusion	Comments
Willis	2009	Memory efficiency and critical thinking among entry-level students	Test whether memory correlates positively with critical thinking	Quiz	50	Good memory positively influences critical thinking	Interesting quiz structure. Framing of critical thinking and memory is too similar, leading to exaggerated correlation.
Qinhua	2011	De Bono Mnemonic places technique and note taking	Examine how the De Bono mnemonic places technique influences note taking	Quiz and note analysis	12	Significant improvement (20%) in 6-strong sample.	One of the better papers on memory impact of note taking. Method useful for constructing experiment for testing critical thinking skills
Summers	2007						
D'Brant	2012						

Example: Literature Review Gap Matrix Table

Author & Year	Topic / Focus	Methodology	Key Findings	Limitation / Boundary	Identified Research Gap
Smith & Lee (2022)	Remote work productivity	Quantitative (Survey, n=250)	Found a 15% increase in short-term task efficiency.	Limited to the tech sector in North America.	Contextual & Population Gap: Lacks data on traditional manufacturing sectors or developing economies.
Patel et al. (2023)	Employee burnout in hybrid models	Mixed methods (Interviews & metrics)	Burnout rises after 6 months of split schedules.	Small qualitative sample size (n=30).	Empirical & Methodological Gap: Lacks large-scale longitudinal tracking of stress biomarkers.
Garcia (2024)	Leadership styles in virtual teams	Qualitative (Case study)	Transformational leadership mitigates isolation.	Focused strictly on startup environments.	Theoretical Gap: Existing leadership frameworks fail to explain remote accountability dynamics.



QUALITY OF INTERNET RESOURCES



➤ **Authority**

- Webpage lists the author and his/her credentials
- author, credentials address, domain name
- .edu,.org or gov.

➤ **Accuracy**

- Who wrote the webpage
- Acknowledgement of the limitations



► **Objectivity**

- Little or no advertising
- Factual information is traceable
- Do the author's express their own opinion, any biasness

► **Currency**

- When the web page and any links it provides are updated regularly.

► **Coverage**

- Coverage is good when you can view the information without paying fees or having additional software requirement



BIBLIOGRAPHY VS REFERENCES

- References include sources that have been directly cited in your paper/Research
- Bibliographies, on the other hand, contain all the sources that you have used for your paper, whether they are directly cited or not. In a bibliography, you should include all of the materials you consulted in preparing your paper



REFERENCING STYLE

- A citation style is a set of rules on how to cite sources in academic writing. Whenever you refer to someone else's work, a citation is required to avoid plagiarism.
 - Citation style guidelines are often published in an official handbook containing explanations, examples, and instructions.
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➤ **MLA**

Modern language association (Languages & Humanities)

➤ **APA**

American Psychological Association (Psychology, education, social sciences)

➤ **Chicago/ Turabian**

University of Chicago (History, humanities Notes)

➤ **Harvard**

University of Harvard (Economics)

➤ **AP**

Association for Press

➤ **Vancouver**

Medicine

➤ **AMA**

American Medical Association

➤ **OSCOLA**

Law Notes



➤ **IEEE**

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers Engineering

➤ **ACS**

American Chemical Society

➤ **NLM**

(National Library of Medicine) Medicine

➤ **AAA**

American Anthropological Association



IN TEXT CITATION

When you refer to a source (for example, by quoting or paraphrasing), you have to add a brief citation in the text. There are three main types of citation:

- **Parenthetical citation:** You put the source reference in parentheses directly in your text. This usually includes the author's last name along with the publication date and/or the page number.
- **Note citation:** You put the source reference in a footnote or endnote.
- **Numeric citation:** You number each of your sources in the reference list and use the correct number when you want to cite a source.



THANK YOU